

0.0.1 Janavasabha (excerpt)

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling in Natika at the brick hall. At that time, at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

2. The [Natika people] heard of the Natika disciples: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the

Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One’s answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

3. The venerable Ananda heard: Apparently at each and every place within the country, the Auspicious One declared the birth of disciples who had died and passed away. Among the Kasis and the Kosalans, the Vajjis and the Mallas, the Cetas and the Vamsas, the Kurus and the Pancalas, the Macchas and the Surasenans: “That one arose there, that one arose there.” “More than fifty disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the five fetters that binds

one to the near shore, come to be born spontaneously, bound to attained final nibbana in that place, not subject to return from that world. More than ninety disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters and the reduction of greed, hatred and delusion, are once-returners, who having come back only once to this world, make the end of suffering. More than five hundred disciples from Natika who had died and passed away, from the complete extinction of the three fetters, are stream-enterers, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.” And by that the Natika disciples, having heard the Auspicious One answer to the question, became pleased, greatly delighted, full of joy and happiness.

4. Then this occurred to the venerable Ananda: “But there were also these Magadhan disciples who have died and passed away, many of whom are really of long standing. One would think that Anga and Magadha are empty of Angans and Magadhans who have died and passed away. Yet, those too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination.

5. Also this king of Magadha, Seniya Bimbisara, was righteous, a lawful king who was a benefactor of Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks. So much so that the citizens dwell singing his praises: “That righteous lawful king, having brought us so much happiness, has passed away. Life was so easy for us in that righteous, lawful king’s kindom.” Yet, he too had confidence in the Buddha, confidence in the Dhamma, confidence in the Sangha, fulfilled in the virtues, [and now] have died and passed away. The Auspicious One has not declared [their birth]. It would be good to have a declaration of them. Many people would gain confidence, and from that, they would go to a happy destination. Besides, the Auspicious One became supremely awakened in Magadha. [Since] the place where the Auspicious One became supremely awakened was in Magadha, why wouldn’t the Auspicious One declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away in that place? Yet, were the Auspicious One not to declare the birth of the Magadhans disciples who have died and passed away, that would be a cause of distress among the Magadhan disciples. But since that would be a cause of distress for the Magadhan disciples, why wouldn’t the Auspicious One make a declaration about them?”